

M. Dalbert Ma

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INTERESTS	AI & Organizations, Human–AI Interaction, Organizational Design, Digital Strategy
EDUCATION	London Business School, PhD in Strategy & Entrepreneurship 2027 IESE Business School, MSc in Management 2020 Pompeu Fabra University, LLM in Law & Economics 2019 University of York, BA in Philosophy, Politics & Economics 2018
JOB MARKET PAPER	[1] Ma, M.D. The Organizational Tradeoff of AI Coordination Abstract: Organizations have long coordinated interdependent work through hierarchy, decentralization, and slack—accommodations to the limits of a single mind. AI operates under far less restrictive bounds, making it possible to hand coordination to a single system; the tradeoffs of doing so remain an open question. I study them at one of the world's largest container ports, where a central AI dispatches autonomous vehicles that operate alone (AI-dominant zones) or alongside independent human-driven trucks (mixed human-AI zones). Across 179,925 tasks over 364 days, I compare the zones across three states of the world. In the steady state, AI-dominant zones are more productive, sustaining a more tightly coupled arrangement than decentralized coordination allows. Under recurrent stochastic shocks—mechanical faults—they contain failures less well, though their net productivity remains higher. Under intense and unanticipated geomagnetic storms, unlike anything in the port's experience, the ranking reverses: the mixed zones outperform. A formal model traces the tradeoff to a single mechanism: unified AI coordination tightens the coupling between activities. Because organizations are open systems, AI's gains on one performance dimension may come at the expense of another. • <i>Awards (2026)</i>: AOM Robert J. Litschert Best Doctoral Student Paper Award; AOM STR Best Paper Award; William H. Newman Award Finalist; SMS Best Paper Prize Nominee • <i>Selected Presentations (2026)</i>: Wharton WINDS, MIT Business Implications of GenAI, Columbia Business School ECDC, Duke Strategy PhD Conference, CCC, Harvard AI Institute OUI Conference, Academy of Management, Oxford ISA, Strategic Management Society
WORKING PAPERS	[2] Jacobides, M.G., Ma, M.D., Das, A., Iyer, S., & Langione, M. Generative AI and the Architecture of Knowledge Work: Expertise Bypass, Exchange Governability, and Shifting Bottlenecks. <i>R&R, Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal</i> [3] Jacobides, M.G. & Ma, M.D. What Are Generative AI's Competitive Implications? A Longitudinal Documentation of Director Expectations. <i>Preparing for submission to Management Science</i> [4] Ma, M.D., Brahm, F., & Sun, S. The Value of Human-in-the-Loop: Evidence from Self-Driving Logistics. <i>Preparing for submission to Management Science</i> [5] Jacobides, M.G. & Ma, M.D. Realizing Physical and Digital Synergies in Multi-Business Firms: A Configurational Approach. <i>Preparing for submission to Organization Science</i>

WORK IN PROGRESS	[6] Ma, M.D. & Vakili, K. Generative AI and the Shifting Locus of Innovation: Start-ups, Incumbents, and Programming Consolidation. <i>Data analysis in progress; IEPC-funded.</i>	
	[7] Ma, M.D. , Puntoni, S., & Jacobides, M.G. Generative AI and Schumpeterian Competition: Shifting Logics in Technological Regimes. <i>Draft in preparation; Wharton AI & Analytics-funded.</i>	
	[8] McElheran, K. & Ma, M.D. Task Interdependence, Causal Ambiguity, and the Attribution of AI's Value: Evidence from a Team-Production Experiment. <i>In design; experimental platform built.</i>	
	[9] Clarke, R. & Ma, M.D. AI Agents and Entrepreneurial Performance: A National Rollout of an AI Operating System. <i>In design; implementation partner secured.</i>	
	[10] Ma, M.D. , Clarke, R., & Cheng, E.Y. Where Do Exceptions Go? Generative AI and Knowledge Hierarchies Inside Firms: Evidence from Enterprise Telemetry. <i>In design; data partnership secured.</i>	
PRACTITIONER PUBLICATIONS	[11] Jacobides, M.G., Ma, M.D. , Trantopoulos, K., & Vassalos, V. 2024. The Business Value of Gamification. <i>California Management Review</i> .	
	[12] Jacobides, M.G. & Ma, M.D. 2024. Assessing the Expected Impact of Generative AI on the UK Competitive Landscape. <i>UK Government Policy Report</i> .	
	[13] Jacobides, M.G., Ma, M.D. , Das, A., & Langione, M. 2026. Generative AI Is Not Just Changing Work. It Is Reallocating It. <i>Forbes</i> .	
SYMPOSIA	Co-organizer, “Diversification in the Digital Age: Should We Rethink Our Premises?” <i>Strategic Management Society Annual Conference (October 2024)</i> . With L. Capron, M.G. Jacobides, G. Lanzolla, C. Markides, P. Puranam, and Y. Romanenkov.	
	Co-organizer, “Opening the Black Box of Diversification: Mechanisms and Dynamics” <i>Academy of Management Annual Meeting (August 2024)</i> . With C. Baldwin, C.E. Helfat, M.G. Jacobides, C. Magelssen, and J. Santalo.	
AWARDS	Academy of Management Robert J. Litschert Best Doctoral Student Paper Award	2026
	Academy of Management STR Division Best Paper Award	2026
	Academy of Management William H. Newman Dissertation Award Finalist	2026
	Strategic Management Society Best Paper Prize (Nominee)	2026
	LBS Sir James Ball Award 25/26 (Runner-Up)	2025
GRANTS	Noorjehan Pirani PhD Fellowship Award, £10,000	2026
	LBS Research & Materials Development Grant, £10,000	2026
	Institute of Entrepreneurship and Private Capital Grant, £9,500	2024
TEACHING	London Business School	
	Tutor, Developing Strategy for Value Creation (EMBA)	2022–2026
	Tutor, Next Generation Digital Strategy (EMBA)	2024–2025
	Teaching Assistant, Profit, Power & Fairness in the Digital Economy (MBA)	2024–2025
	Tutor, Aramco Executive Finance Strategy Programme (EMBA)	2025

CASE STUDIES	Tanla & Indosat: Building an AI-Powered Shield Against a National Crisis, LBS 2026 Building the Phygital Ecosystem: The Journey of Majid Al Futtaim, LBS 2024 Facing the Retail Apocalypse: Majid Al Futtaim's Transformation, LBS 2024 HDFC ERGO: A Product Ecosystem Built on Mindshare, LBS 2024 From PingAn's Inspiration to HDFC ERGO's Journey, LBS 2024 From Products to Experience Ecosystems: Haier's Internet of Food, LBS 2022 Bridgewater Associates: Chasing Alpha, IESE 2022 Technical Note: Central Bank Digital Currencies, IESE 2022 Technical Note: Challenger Banks, IESE 2022	
SERVICE	<i>Ad-hoc Reviewer:</i> Industrial and Corporate Change, Long Range Planning <i>Conference Reviewer:</i> AOM Annual Conference, Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference, LBS Ghoshal Conference, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference	
ADDITIONAL	Citizenship: USA Languages: English, Mandarin, Spanish (Intermediate)	
SKILLS	Computing: STATA, Python, R, MATLAB, BigQuery, L^AT_EX	
REFERENCES	Michael G. Jacobides Sir Donald Gordon Professor of Entrepreneurship & Innovation London Business School mjacobides@london.edu	Keyvan Vakili Associate Professor of Strategy & Entrepreneurship London Business School kvakili@london.edu
	Francisco Brahm Assistant Professor of Strategy & Entrepreneurship London Business School fbrahm@london.edu	

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